



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

STATE 2023

PRELIMINARY

Presentation Points	_____ (140 points)
Specification Points	_____ (20 points)
TOTAL POINTS	_____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

GENERAL GUIDELINES:

Failure to adhere to any of the following rules will result in disqualification:

1. Contestant must hand in this test booklet and all printouts if any.
2. No equipment, supplies, or materials other than those specified for this event are allowed in the testing area. No previous BPA tests and/or sample tests (handwritten, photocopied, or keyed) are allowed in the testing area.
3. Electronic devices will be monitored according to ACT standards.

DESCRIPTION:

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

STATE PRELIMINARY SCENARIO KEY:

Cody, a recently hired employee in the Marketing Department of Digital Solutions, is about to sign a new client to a \$100,000 contract. As he is reviewing the contract with his boss, she quietly closes the door to her office and discloses that sales this quarter are far below projections. After telling Cody that she is under a lot of pressure to increase sales, with her job and possibly others on the line, she asks him to include the revenue from his new contract in the sales figures for the quarter than ends tomorrow. Cody is confident that the contract is a sure thing; however, the new client is traveling abroad and cannot possibly sign by tomorrow.

- What are Cody's next steps?
- What, if any, company ethics policies were violated in this scenario?
- What impact will Cody's decision(s) have on his career advancement with Digital Solutions?
- How will Digital Solutions' reputation and future relationship with the new client be impacted based on his decision?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism Resources Manual*:

- Page 3 - Open communication is conducting professional business with transparency and dual freedom to exchange information.
- Page 3- Equal opportunities is ensuring those around you and those you engage in business transactions are given the respect, honesty, and fairness needed to perform in the workplace.
- Page 3 - Digital Solutions' employees agree to uphold the following standards:
 - take responsibility for my actions, decisions, and obligations
 - make honest and transparent decisions which are good for all involved
 - encourage actions, policies, and procedures which promote high standards for conduct and professionalism
 - uphold and respect the laws that govern my work

- Page 5 – Integrity is the foundation on which good commerce is built and involves holding to your principles even when it would be easier or more profitable to compromise them.
- Page 5 – Trustworthiness: neither you nor your business can succeed with a reputation for untrustworthiness.
- Page 5 – Internal + External: good business practice requires that ethical behavior be practiced both internally as well as outside the business.
- Page 6 – Paying respect to co-workers, oneself, and clients, being honest during any type of transaction, and taking responsibility for one's own actions is both ethical and professional. Today's employees are looking for a workplace that exhibits positive ethical and professional values.
- Page 6 – Professionalism allows for heightened respect from clients, thereby opening greater lines of communication and potentially increased trust.
- Page 7 – Effective communication skills will give you an advantage over most of your colleagues. Knowing how to efficiently communicate your message will enable you to increase the amount of influence that you will have in dealing with your peers, supervisors, and subordinates.
- Page 9 – Confidentiality is critical in many professional engagements and is key to organizational risk management and both personal and professional liability.